



YOU ARE **24 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

108 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This 3-D scan shows the baby thumb sucking. The technique uses several routine 2-D images, linked together to give the 3-D effect. In a 4-D scan, a series of 3-D images are shown in quick succession to give almost real-time movements: the 4th dimension is time.

“A natural temperature-regulating mechanism within the uterus means your baby never gets cold.”

The temperature inside the uterus is between a third and half a degree higher than yours. Because your body temperature is so closely controlled, your baby never becomes cold so never needs to shiver. They've started to lay down a special form of brown fat, particularly around the neck, chest, and back. After birth, metabolism of this fat produces both energy and heat. In the uterus, however, the baby cannot use this fat to raise their temperature. Some temperature control occurs as heat is lost from the baby's skin into the amniotic fluid through the uterine wall and then into your body tissues. However, the regulation of temperature is predominantly achieved by means of the blood flow to the placenta. The large surface area of the placenta allows it to act as a heat exchange, keeping the temperature of the blood leaving the baby in the umbilical arteries constant with that of the oxygenated blood returning to the baby through the umbilical vein.

After birth, babies lose heat quickly. They are still unable to shiver and cannot maintain their temperature, cooling rapidly if they're not wrapped up warmly or held skin-to-skin shortly after the birth.

SENSIBLE SNACKING

As your pregnancy progresses, you may find that you can't eat large meals and that you prefer smaller meals and snacks. If you are on the go, try:

- Unsalted nuts or seeds.
- Pretzels, oatcakes, rice or corn cakes, and breadsticks.
- Dried fruits, which are a good source of iron, so try dried peaches, figs, and prunes, as well as raisins and apricots. Opt for unsweetened versions when possible.
- An apple or clementine.

If you're at home, other nutritious mini meals or snacks can include eggs, cheese, or soup. A slice of whole-wheat toast makes a great partner for chicken salad, nut butters, cheese, or eggs. Try to include a vegetable with each snack, such as grated carrots, slices of red bell peppers or celery, a few cherry tomatoes, or some arugula.